## Definition of Research

Research is a systematic and scientific process to solve problems or to answer to questions about facts. Nursing research focuses primarily on developing knowledge about nursing including the care of person in health and illness.

In general, Nursing research is defined as the systematic objective process of analysing phenomena of importance to nursing.

According to **Waltz** and **Bausell** (1981) Nursing research is a systematic formal rigorous process used to gain solutions to problem or to discover and interpret new facts in clinical practice, nursing education and nursing administration.

**Wilson** (1980) Differentiated nursing research and research in nursing. In that nursing research is concerned with clinical problem. Whereas research in nursing is the broader study of the nursing profession which includes historical, ethical and policy studies.

## 13.1 Importance of Research in Nursing

1. Research builds an advanced body of nursing knowledge.
2. Research provides a cost effective, and efficient health care.
3. Research moulds the attitude and improves technical skills.
4. Research fills the gap and helps in finding out new knowledge of practice.
5. Research makes individual health care responsiblity and decision making in health related problems.
6. Research modifies the old theories and discovers new theories.
7. Research adopts evidence based practice, while providing care or health education to those who are in need.
8. Research develops knowledge about the current issues happening in medical field.
9. Research provides scientific basis for the practice of the nursing profession on need based intervention.
10. Research prepares the individuals to be a nurse scientists.

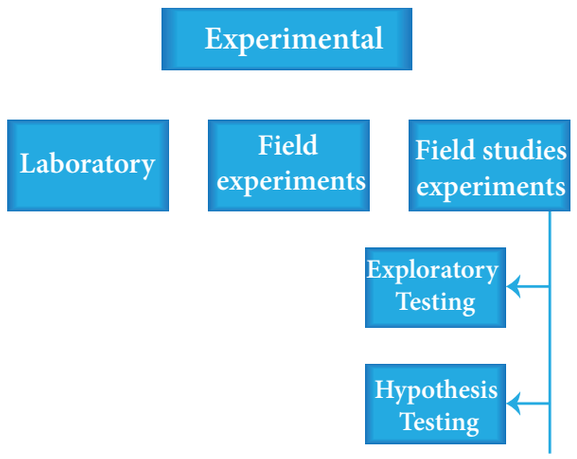
## 13.2 Types of Research

Research is classified according to their purposes and approaches.

- **Basic research or fundamental research** are carried out in laboratory situations
- **Applied research** helps to evaluate practices and identifies the needs of the person
- **Action research** tries to solve ongoing problems

## Research Approaches

There are two types of Research Approaches. Namely Experimental and Non Experimental




## 13.3 Steps in Nursing Research

- Identification of the phenomenon/ problem of the study
- Review of literature
- Deriving conceptual frame work



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